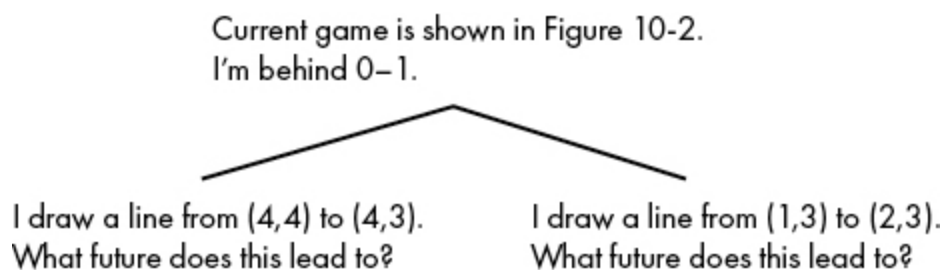


opponent is trying to minimize our score. The constant fight between our maximization and our opponent's minimization is what we have to strategically consider as we're choosing the right move.

Let's look closely at the simple game tree in [Figure 10-3](#). In theory, a game tree can grow to be enormous, with a huge depth and many branches at each depth. But any game tree, big or small, consists of the same components: a lot of little nested branches.

At the point we're considering in [Figure 10-3](#), we have two choices. [Figure 10-4](#) shows them.



[Figure 10-4](#): Considering which of two moves to choose

Our goal is to maximize our score. To decide between these two moves, we need to know what they will lead to, what future each move brings to pass. To know that, we need to travel farther down the game tree and look at all the possible consequences. Let's start with the move on the right ([Figure 10-5](#)).